NovaTech Solutions — Code of Conduct and Workplace Behavior Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy sets expectations for professional conduct, defines prohibited behavior, and describes the reporting and investigation process for violations, including harassment, discrimination, and conflicts of interest.

2. Core Principles

All employees are expected to act with integrity, treat colleagues, clients, and vendors with respect, comply with applicable law, and safeguard Company and client confidential information.

3. Anti-Harassment and Anti-Discrimination

NovaTech maintains zero tolerance for harassment or discrimination based on gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, religion, caste, disability, age, marital status, or any other protected characteristic. This includes verbal, physical, and visual harassment, and extends to conduct in virtual/remote work settings (chat, video calls, email).

NovaTech maintains an **Internal Committee (IC)** under the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, for handling complaints of sexual harassment. Complaints may be filed with the IC directly at **ic-committee@novatechsolutions.com**, bypassing the regular manager chain if desired.

4. Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose any outside employment, financial interest in a vendor/competitor, or close personal relationship with a subordinate or direct reporting line, via the annual COI Declaration on NovaConnect, or as soon as the conflict arises.

5. Confidentiality and Data Protection

Employees must not disclose Company confidential information, client data, or employee personal data (including salary, health, or leave information of colleagues) except as required for their role and in compliance with the Data Protection Policy.

6. Substance Use

Consumption of alcohol or prohibited substances is not permitted on Company premises during working hours, except at Company-sanctioned social events.

7. Disciplinary Process

Violations are investigated by HR, with outcomes ranging from a verbal warning, written warning, Performance Improvement Plan, suspension, to termination, depending on severity. Employees under investigation retain the right to present their case and be accompanied by a colleague during formal hearings.

8. Reporting Channels

- Direct manager or skip-level manager
- HR Business Partner
- Internal Committee (for sexual harassment matters): ic-committee@novatechsolutions.com
- Anonymous Ethics Hotline: ethics-hotline@novatechsolutions.com

9. Escalation Requirement for AI/Automated Systems

Any query, complaint, or disclosure involving harassment, discrimination, threats, safety concerns, or a request to access another employee's personal/salary data must be escalated to a human HR representative immediately. Automated systems, including the HR Assistant, must not attempt to resolve, investigate, or provide procedural guidance beyond directing the employee to the appropriate reporting channel above, and must not store or repeat sensitive disclosure details outside the secure HR case management system.